

NEW PET CHECKLIST (To Help Identify Qualified Applicants With A Dog)

Point System. The applicant may meet your minimum criteria for renting a home. However, if you accept residents with a dog, use this checklist to determine if the “dog” qualifies. Give a score of one point for each of the following criteria. It is okay to designate any criteria to be worth more than one point, if you deem certain criteria more important than others as long as you are consistent in giving the same value to select criteria for all applicants. Add up the total points to see if the dog reaches your minimum acceptable score.

Note: If the dog does not qualify and the owner says that they will get rid of the dog so that they can still rent the home, that is NOT a good indicator of a responsible resident. **It should also be noted** that “service animals” are not legally considered as “pets” and are exempt from the following criteria.

CRITERIA: Point 1 point (or more) in front of each of the following criteria which the dog meets.

- _____ Applicant willing and able to pay additional \$_____ deposit.
- _____ Applicant willing and able to pay additional \$_____ monthly rent.
- Applicant will obtain renter’s insurance with liability coverage for the dog.
- _____ Dogs is at least 12 months of age or older.
- _____ Dog was given a satisfactory reference from previous landlord.
- _____ Applicant is able to provide a veterinary reference for their dog.
- _____ Dog has received veterinary care in the past 12 months.
- _____ Dog is NOT one of the following breeds, (fully or partially), Pit bull, Terriers, Rottweiler, German Shepherd, Husky-Alaskan malamute, Doberman Pincher, Chow Chow, Great Dane, Saint Bernard, Akita, Mastiff, or Wolf hybrids.
- _____ Applicant does not try to misrepresent the breed of the dog.
- _____ Applicant does not claim that dog will never go into the house.
- _____ Dogs is able to demonstrate during interview that it is well-behaved and has good manners.
- _____ Dog (or applicant) does not growl nor stare during the interview nor demonstrate any sign of aggressive behavior.
- _____ Dog (and applicant) appears clean and well groomed
- _____ Dog is wearing clothing made specifically for dogs.
- _____ Applicant is able to easily control the pet during the entire showing and application process.
- _____ Dog has no history of complaints from previous neighbors (regarding noise or behavior)
- _____ Dog has no history of attacks or biting of humans or other animals.
- _____ Applicant has proof that dog has had current rabies vaccination.
- _____ Applicant has proof that dog has been neutered.
- _____ Applicant does not allow dog to roam free at any time during the showing without a leash.
- _____ **Dog’s Total Score – (A total score of _____ points is acceptable)**

Applicant’s name _____ **Date Applied** _____ **Phone** _____

Dangerous Dog Breeds Banned by Many Insurance Companies

Here's a list of the 14 dog breeds that appear on many insurance company exclusion lists. Looking at various uninsurable dog lists, there is a reasonable amount of variability as to which breeds were to be allowed or disallowed. Still there were 14 breeds of dogs which appeared on virtually all of the lists. Most of these breeds blacklisted are not only the specific breed but any mixed breed that presumably included a genetic relationship to one of the banned breeds. These dogs may or may not be on your insurers blacklist because each one maintains its own list based on their own proprietary risk data. The 14 most often blacklisted dog breeds are as follows:

Pitt Bull Terriers

Staffordshire Terriers

Rottweilers

German Shepherds

Presa Canarios

Chows Chows

Doberman Pinschers

Akitas

Wolf-hybrids

Bull Mastiffs

Cane Corsos

Great Danes

Alaskan Malamutes

Siberian Huskies

So what does this mean for landlords? In order to protect their investment and ensure that their insurance coverage extends to cover any dog bite incidents, landlords must specifically ask their insurance agent about whether or not the company has a list of banned dog breeds.

Once the landlord determines if such a list exists, they can make the decision of whether to continue to be a customer of the company or shop around for a non-discriminatory insurance company, if they are offering pet-friendly properties. If the landlord decides they must stick with their current insurance company, he or she needs to make sure all applicants and tenants are not owners of any of the banned breeds of dogs.

The best way to do this is during the application process, and asking questions about pets. Many landlords have a short information sheet that lists the banned dog breed. They can hand out this paper during the application process or include it in the information packet for the rental property during an open house.

Banned dog breeds should also be listed by name in the lease agreement or as an addendum to the lease. If tenants move in without a dog and later acquire one that is on the banned dog breeds list, the landlord can consider this a violation of the lease agreement and there is grounds for a Comply or Quit Notice that could lead to eviction.

Pet-friendly rental properties are highly desirable and landlords that allow dogs, especially with no restrictions on breeds or sizes will usually have plenty of applicants when a unit is vacant. It may seem unfortunate that most of the time, dog attacks are a result of poor training and bad owners rather than the dogs themselves, but landlords must take everything into consideration regarding pets, and dogs in particular, to see what makes the most sense for their business.

Assistance Animal Application Process / Form

Procedures for requesting an Assistance Animal in our homes or apartments are outlined below:

A person requesting permission to keep an Assistance Animal must make a request. To do so, the person should submit this "Assistance Animal Request Form" as well as submit the following:

- Documentation of certification of the individual's disability or condition from a physician, psychiatrist, social worker, or other mental health professional.
- Documentation of the need for an Assistance Animal, which should include a statement on how the animal helps or serves as an accommodation for the verified disability, and/or how the need for the animal relates to the ability of the resident to use and enjoy the housing.
- Documentation should state that it is for a specific animal. If a resident chooses to request to keep a different Assistance Animal, they must submit new documentation for that animal.
- Rental management will review documentation and, if the documentation meets the criteria for approval, management shall arrange a meeting with the person (and animal) making the request. During the meeting, policies and rules will be reviewed with the person at that time and an addendum will be signed indicating that they understand and agree to the conditions of the policies.

Applicant/resident requesting permission for animal assistance _____

Describe your reason for requesting an assistance animal _____

What type of assistance animal do you have? _____

How does this specific animal help or serve as an accommodation? _____

What breed is the animal? _____ Weight _____

Has it received all necessary vaccinations?___ Is it licensed?___ (please attach documentation)

Emergency Contact (If there is a problem connected with the animal)

Name _____ Phone: _____